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Part 1 — Organizational Foundations

1. Name of the Association

The name of the organization is:

"Sew Le Sew Mutual Aid Association of Calgary."

Background Note: The Association was originally formed in memory of *Samuel*, a child who tragically passed away in Calgary after being born in Kenya during displacement. Although the Association's name has since evolved, youth programs, sports initiatives, and community development activities operating under the "Samuel Memorial" identity may continue to use that name as part of the Association's broader social and community development work.

2. Foundational Principles of the Association

2.1 Vision

To become a leading, resilient, and future-ready mutual aid institution in Canada — capable, prepared, and dependable for today, tomorrow, and generations to come.

2.2 Mission

To build and strengthen a sustainable, intergenerational community support system by:

- Responding to rapid economic, social, cultural, and technological changes
- Leveraging knowledge and modern tools
- Developing strong organizational capacity
- Ensuring continuity of mutual support from one generation to the next

2.3 Core Values

Unity: We stand together, support one another, and collectively address shared challenges and aspirations.

Equity & Inclusion: We value all members equally, without discrimination based on background, race, identity, or circumstance. Every member's contribution is respected and appreciated.

Transparency & Accountability: Our decisions, financial management, and use of resources are guided by fairness, clarity, and the collective interests of our members.

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Giving & Receiving: We uphold a culture of mutual support — sharing time, knowledge, resources, and financial contributions for the collective good.

Sustainability: We plan with the future in mind, building systems and structures that ensure long-term service to our community.

Neutrality: The Association is free from political, religious, and ethnic bias. Membership and services are provided without favoritism or discrimination.

2.4 Objectives of the Association

1. **Mutual Support in Times of Loss:** To collectively share the emotional, physical, and financial burdens associated with the death of a member or a member's dependent.
2. **Support During Emergencies and Illness:** To provide timely assistance to members facing accidents, illness, or unexpected hardship.
3. **Strengthening Social Bonds:** To expand and reinforce networks of friendship, solidarity, and shared joy among members.
4. **Conflict Resolution:** To promote peaceful resolution of disputes within the community using cultural and traditional approaches.
5. **Support for Vulnerable Members:** To identify and assist elderly members, individuals with health challenges, and others requiring special support.
6. **Youth Engagement:** To design and implement programs that encourage youth participation and leadership, ensuring continuity of the Association across generations.
7. **Support for Newcomers:** To assist new immigrants and newcomers to Calgary and surrounding areas through orientation, guidance, and community integration programs.
8. **Community Emergency Response:** To mobilize members and collaborate with local authorities during community crises, disasters, or unexpected events.
9. **Cultural Exchange and Community Relations:** To strengthen relationships with other cultural groups, organizations, and communities through joint programs and cultural exchange.
10. **Legal and Civic Education:** To educate members about Canadian laws, rights, responsibilities, and available services through training and awareness programs.
11. **Sponsorship and Settlement Support:** To facilitate sponsorship programs for refugees and newcomers, and to coordinate related administrative and community support activities integration programs.
12. **Community Emergency Response:** To mobilize members and collaborate with local authorities during community crises, disasters, or unexpected events.
13. **Cultural Exchange and Community Relations:** To strengthen relationships with other cultural groups, organizations, and communities through joint programs and cultural exchange.
14. **Legal and Civic Education:** To educate members about Canadian laws, rights, responsibilities, and available services through training and awareness programs.

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PART 2 - DEFINITIONS & MEMBERSHIP PROVISIONS

3. Definitions

For the purposes of these Bylaws, the following terms shall have the meanings assigned below:

3.1 “Association”

Refers to the **Sew Le Sew Mutual Aid Association of Calgary**, a community-based mutual support organization established to provide collective assistance to its members.

3.2 “Iddir / Mutual Aid”

“Iddir” is a traditional Ethiopian community support system passed down through generations, designed to provide mutual assistance during times of hardship, loss, and community need.

3.3 “Bylaws”

The internal governing document that outlines the rules, procedures, and operational framework of the Association.

3.4 “Member”

Any individual who meets the membership requirements outlined in these Bylaws, completes registration, and is formally recognized as a member in good standing.

3.5 “Child / Dependent”

A biological or adopted child of a member, or a child legally or culturally placed under the care of a member (including through guardianship or traditional arrangements) and registered as part of the member’s household.

3.6 “Youth”

For the purposes of these Bylaws, “Youth” refers to individuals aged **15 to 29**, in alignment with Canadian youth policy frameworks.

3.7 “Board of Directors”

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The governing body of the Association, composed of **seven (7)** elected members responsible for leadership, oversight, and executive decision-making.

3.8 "Officers"

Volunteers appointed under the Board of Directors to support program delivery, project execution, and administrative functions.

3.9 "Sub-Committee"

A volunteer group formed under the Board of Directors to carry out specific services, programs, or operational tasks.

3.10 Gender Reference

Any gendered terms used in these Bylaws apply equally to all genders and should be interpreted in an inclusive manner.

4. Membership

4.1 Membership Eligibility Requirements

Any individual may become a member of the Association if they:

1. Accept and agree to abide by the objectives and Bylaws of the Association
2. Are **18 years of age or older**
3. Hold Canadian citizenship, permanent residency, or a valid residency permit
4. Reside within the Association's defined geographic service area (see Section 4.2)

4.2 Geographic Membership Boundary

Membership is open to individuals residing in:

- **Calgary**
- **Chestermere**
- **Airdrie**
- **Cochrane**
- **Okotoks**
- And other communities within **25 km** of Calgary city limits

As the Association grows, the Board of Directors may expand this boundary based on community needs and service capacity.

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Service delivery and support within each community shall follow the operational guidelines established by the Board of Directors.

4.3 Membership Categories

To ensure inclusive and comprehensive service, the Association recognizes the following membership categories:

4.3.1 Household Membership

A membership that includes:

- Married couples or partners
- Their children (biological, adopted, or guardianship) up to age 25

Note: Temporary visitors such as parents, siblings, or relatives staying with a member under a short-term visitor visa are **not** included under Household Membership.

4.3.2 Youth Membership

For individuals under age 29 who are:

- Children of members
- Children of deceased members
- Students or young adults living independently
- Youth wishing to contribute through volunteerism, skills, or community engagement

Youth Membership is designed to strengthen intergenerational continuity and leadership.

4.3.3 Individual Membership

For adults who meet the eligibility criteria and wish to join independently rather than as part of a household.

If an individual later forms a household (through marriage or family expansion), they may convert to Household Membership by notifying the Association and updating their registration.

4.3.4 Temporary Membership

For individuals who:

- Are visiting Calgary or surrounding cites listed in section 4.2 temporarily

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- Hold a temporary resident or visitor permit
- Are staying with a member household for short-term reasons (e.g., caregiving, study, temporary work assignment)

Temporary Membership is valid for **up to 12 months** and includes limited benefits as defined in the Benefits Policy.

4.3.5 Newcomer Membership

For individuals who have lived in Canada for **less than 18 months** and meet one of the following:

- Permanent residents
- Refugee claimants
- Sponsored newcomers

This membership supports integration and community connection.

4.3.6 Honorary Membership

Granted to individuals or organizations that have made exceptional contributions to the Association or the broader community.

Honorary Members:

- Do **not** pay registration or monthly fees
- Do **not** receive financial benefits
- Serve as ambassadors, advisors, or supporters of the Association's mission

4.3.7 Partner Organization Membership

For community organizations, faith groups, or associations that collaborate with the Mutual Aid Association.

Partner Organizations:

- Share resources, space, or expertise as possible, mutually agreed and approved
- Support community events, emergencies, or cultural programs
- Do not pay membership fees
- Do not receive financial benefits

Their participation strengthens community capacity and collective response during emergency

PART 3 - MEMBERSHIP FEES, RIGHTS, RESPONSIBILITIES.

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4.4 Membership Fees and Contributions

4.4.1 Registration Fee (Entrance Fee)

General Principle and Householed membership: The registration fee is calculated based on:

1. A new Household Member pays **65%** of the calculated per-member share as the registration fee after the Association's current financial capital is divided by the number of active members.

   The 2026 calculated **registration of $1,105 CAD** and will be valid for **two consecutive years** from the date these Bylaws take effect. After that, the Board of Directors will reassess and adjust the fee every two years based on updated financial analysis.

2. **Individual Membership:** Individuals joining independently (not as a household) pay **60%** of the household registration fee.
3. **Youth Membership:** Youth Members **do not pay a registration fee**. They only pay the monthly contribution defined in Section 4.4.3.
4. **Temporary Membership:** Temporary Members pay **30%** of the standard household membership registration fee, plus the regular monthly contribution. Temporary Membership is valid for **12 months only**.
5. **Newcomer Membership:** Newcomers also pay **30%** of the standard household registration fee, plus the regular monthly contribution.
6. **Honorary Members:** Honorary Members pay **no registration fee** and **no monthly contribution**, as their membership is symbolic and recognition-based.
7. **Partner Organizations:** Partner organizations do **not** pay registration or monthly fees.

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4.4.2 Summary of Membership Categories, Voting Rights, Fees, Benefits & Purpose

Below is a summary table:

Table: Membership Categories Overview

Membership Type	Voting Rights	Fees	Benefits	Purpose
Household Membership	Yes	Registration + Monthly	Full benefits as defined in these Bylaws	Strengthen family-based mutual support
Individual Membership	Yes	Registration + Monthly	Full benefits	Enable individuals to participate independently
Youth Membership	Yes	Monthly only	Limited benefits (non-financial)	Build intergenerational continuity and leadership
Newcomer Membership	Yes	Registration + Monthly	Full benefits after qualifying period	Support integration of new arrivals
Temporary Membership	Yes	Registration + Monthly	Limited benefits	Provide short-term support for temporary residents
Honorary Membership	No	None	Symbolic only	Recognize exceptional contributors
Partner Organizations	No	None	Shared community benefits	Strengthen collaboration and community capacity

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Notes:

- "Yes" under Voting Rights means the member can vote in association matters; "No" means they cannot.
- "Monthly and registration" fees refer to regular dues and a one-time registration fee.
- Honorary and Partner Organization memberships are mostly symbolic or based on resource sharing, not monetary contributions.
- Each membership type has a specific purpose, either for individuals, families, youth, newcomers, or organizations.

4.4.3 Monthly Contributions

All active members (except Honorary and Partner Members) must pay a **monthly contribution** of CD25.00 until reviewed for adjustment and determined by the Board of Directors for an increase. The monthly fee:

- Supports the Association's operational costs
- Funds emergency support and benefits
- Ensures sustainability of programs and services

The Board reviews and adjusts the monthly contribution as needed, based on financial assessments.

4.5 Continuation of Membership

4.5.1 Continuation as a Household Member

A Household Member remains active as long as:

- Monthly contributions are paid
- Registration information is kept up to date

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- The member continues to reside within the geographic boundary

4.5.2 Continuation After Divorce or Separation

If a household dissolves due to divorce or separation:

- Each adult may continue membership independently
- Each must update their membership category and registration form
- Benefits will be recalculated based on the new membership status

4.5.3 Temporary Member Transition to Permanent Membership

A Temporary Member who becomes a permanent resident or relocates permanently to Calgary may:

- Apply to convert to Household or Individual Membership
- Pay the remaining portion of the standard registration fee
- Update their membership information accordingly

4.6 Termination of Membership

Membership may be terminated under the following conditions:

4.6.1 Voluntary Withdrawal

A member may withdraw by:

- Submitting written notice
- Settling any outstanding obligations
- Returning any Association property (e.g., ID card)

4.6.2 Change of Residence

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Membership may be terminated if a member permanently relocates outside the Association's geographic boundary.

4.6.3 Termination for Misconduct

Membership may be revoked for:

- Violating the Bylaws: Any breach of the Association's governing rules.
- Fraudulent Activity: Engaging in dishonest or deceptive actions.
- Abuse of Benefits: Misusing the support or services provided by the Association.
- Actions that Harm the Association's Reputation or Operations: Any conduct that damages the standing or effective functioning of the Association.
- Serious Misconduct: This includes acting against the Association's goals and core values, damaging its reputation, or engaging in behavior based on politics, discrimination, or religious bias. If such behavior is found to harm the unity of the members, and is confirmed, the member will be expelled from the Association.

The Board of Directors will conduct a fair review before making a final decision.

4.6.4 Suspension

A member may be suspended for:

- Non-payment of monthly contributions
- Failure to update required information
- Other administrative issues

Suspended members lose access to benefits until reinstated.

4.6.5 Reinstatement

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A former member may be reinstated if:

- They submit a reinstatement request
- Outstanding fees are paid
- The Board approves the reinstatement

Reinstatement terms may vary depending on the reason for termination.

4.7 Rights and Responsibilities of Members

4.7.1 Responsibilities

Members must:

- Pay monthly contributions on time
- Follow the Bylaws and policies
- Participate in meetings and community activities
- Provide accurate and updated personal information
- When elected, members are expected to provide voluntary services and leadership in their professional area and based on their experience.
- Uphold the values and reputation of the Association

4.7.2 Rights

Members have the right to:

- Vote in General Assembly meetings
- Access benefits according to their membership category
- Receive transparent financial and operational information
- Participate in elections and committees

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- Propose ideas, raise concerns, and contribute to decision-making

4.8 Membership Identification

4.8.1 Membership Card

Each member receives an official **Membership ID Card** issued by the Association.

4.8.2 When the ID Card May Be Required

Members may be asked to present their ID card when:

- Accessing benefits
- Participating in official Association activities
- Verifying membership status

4.8.3 Replacement or Renewal of ID Cards

A membership card must be replaced or updated if:

- Lost or damaged
- Personal information changes
- The membership category changes

PART 4 — ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE & GOVERNANCE

5. Organizational Structure

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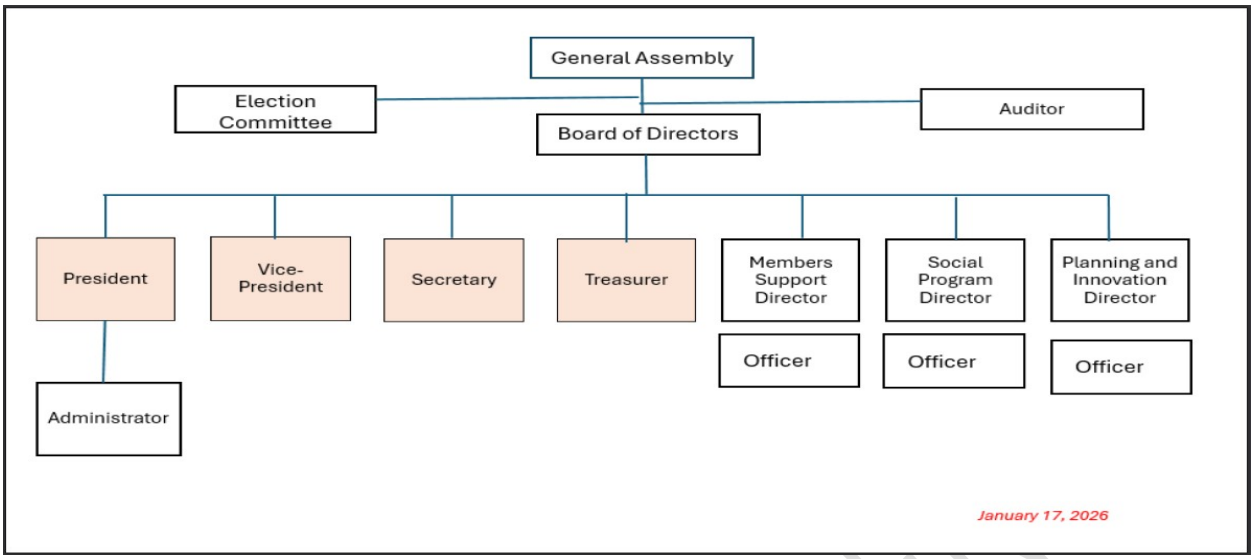

The Sew Le Sew Mutual Aid Association operates through a structured governance system designed to ensure accountability, transparency, and effective service delivery. The Association's organizational structure consists of:

1. **The General Assembly**
2. **The Board of Directors**
3. **Standing and Ad-hoc Committees**
4. **Officers and Program Leads**
5. **Sub-Committees and Volunteer Teams**

Each body plays a distinct role in decision-making, oversight, and program implementation.

6. Governance Bodies, Roles & Responsibilities

6.1 The General Assembly

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The **General Assembly** is the highest decision-making authority of the Association. It is composed of all active members in good standing.

Powers and Responsibilities of the General Assembly

- Approve and amend the Bylaws
- Elect the Board of Directors
- Review and approve annual reports, financial statements, and strategic plans
- Provide direction on major organizational decisions
- Hold the Board accountable for performance and compliance
- Approve major policy changes, membership fee adjustments, and long-term initiatives

Meetings

- The General Assembly meets **at least once per year** for the Annual General Meeting (AGM).
- Special meetings may be called by the Board or by a petition of members as defined in the Bylaws.
- Quorum requirements and voting procedures are defined in the Elections and Meetings section (Part 10).

6.2 Elections Committee

The **Elections Committee** is an independent body responsible for:

- Managing the nomination and election process
- Ensuring fairness, transparency, and compliance with the Bylaws

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- Preparing ballots, voter lists, and election materials
- Overseeing vote counting and announcing results
- Handling election-related complaints or disputes

The Committee operates throughout the election period and is also responsible for refilling any vacant positions that arise during its three-year term.

6.3 Auditor

The **Auditor** is responsible for:

- Reviewing the Association's financial records
- Ensuring accuracy, transparency, and compliance with financial policies
- Preparing an annual audit report for the General Assembly
- Advising the Board on financial risks and internal controls

The Auditor may be an internal volunteer with financial expertise or an external professional, depending on the Association's needs and resources.

6.4 Board of Directors

The **Board of Directors** is the executive leadership body of the Association. It consists of **seven (7)** elected members.

Mandate of the Board

The Board is responsible for:

- Providing strategic leadership and oversight
- Ensuring the Association fulfills its mission and objectives
- Managing finances, programs, and operations

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- Approving policies, budgets, and major initiatives
- Representing the Association in external relations
- Ensuring compliance with Canadian laws and nonprofit standards

Board Meetings

- The Board meets regularly (monthly or as needed).
- Decisions are made by majority vote unless otherwise specified.
- Minutes must be recorded and made available to members upon request.

7. Roles & Responsibilities of Directors and Officers

Below is a professionally structured breakdown of leadership roles.

7.1 President

The President serves as the chief executive leader of the Association.

Key Responsibilities

- Provide overall leadership and direction
- Chair Board and General Assembly meetings
- Represent the Association in official matters
- Ensure implementation of Board decisions
- Oversee strategic planning and organizational development
- Serve as the primary spokesperson

7.1.1. Office Administrative Support Officer

- **Scope of Responsibilities and Compensation:**
  The responsibilities and compensation for this position are reviewed and determined by the

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Board of Directors, in consultation with department heads. The scope depends on the association's capacity and workload.

- **Appointment Process:**
  The appointment is carried out by a committee that is designated by the president of the Association.

Main Duties and Responsibilities:

- **Managing Administrative Tasks:**
  Oversee and implement the association's various administrative office tasks.
- **Membership Records:**
  Review and ensure the accuracy and completeness of membership records, in collaboration with responsible staff for approval and verification.
- **Handling Inquiries:**
  Respond to administrative requests and inquiries from members and the office.
- **Supporting Executives:**
  Carry out administrative tasks as assigned by the executive director and other responsible officials.

7.2 Vice President

The Vice President supports the President and acts on their behalf when necessary.

Key Responsibilities

- Assist with leadership duties
- Oversee internal coordination among committees
- Step in as Acting President when required
- Support strategic initiatives and member engagement

7.3 Secretary

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The Secretary manages documentation, communication, and record-keeping.

Key Responsibilities

- Maintain accurate meeting minutes
- Manage official correspondence
- Keep membership records updated
- Maintain organizational documents and archives
- Support communication between the Board and members

7.4 Treasurer / Director of Finance & Assets

The Treasurer oversees financial management and asset control.

Key Responsibilities

- Manage financial records, bank accounts, and transactions
- Prepare financial reports and budgets
- Ensure compliance with financial policies
- Oversee fundraising and revenue management
- Safeguard the Association's assets and property

7.7.1. Finance and Property Officer(s)

Role and Responsibilities:

14.1 The officers' Committee Composition:

The sub-committee must have at least three members. The coordinator is assigned by the Director of the Division from among volunteer members.

14.2 Financial Management:

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- Ensure all collected funds (monthly dues, registration, penalties, donations, and other income) are properly deposited into the bank.
- Verify that recipients sign for expenses and that payment processes follow instructions.
- Provide information about funds or documents when requested by the association, external auditors, department heads, or the accountant.
- Prepare and securely keep financial records and statements.
- Manage petty cash for minor expenses and oversee withdrawals from the bank for budgeted expenses.

14.3 Accounting and Reporting:

- Monitor and control the association's income and expenses.
- Initiate requests for approval of financial documents through the appropriate division process.
- Prepare monthly financial activity reports for the Director of the Division.
- Collaborate with internal and external stakeholders as needed

7.5 Director of Support Services

This role oversees the delivery of mutual aid services, including funeral support, emergency assistance, and related programs.

Key Responsibilities

- Coordinate support services for members in need
- Manage volunteers involved in support delivery
- Ensure timely and respectful service provision
- Maintain records of support cases and outcomes

7.5.1. Samuel House Burial and Emergency Aid Administration Officers

Roles and Responsibilities:

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14.4 The officers' Committee Composition:

This sub-committee must have at least three members. The Coordinator of the Committee is assigned by the Director of the Division among its volunteer members.

14.5 Scope of Support:

The committee is responsible for determining the type and amount of support provided by the association in cases of death, serious illness, natural or man-made disasters, or other emergencies. The support can be financial, material, or organizational, depending on the situation.

14.6 Immediate Response:

When a member passes away, based on a family or friend's report, the committee immediately begins the process of verifying the situation and preparing the necessary support.

14.7 Coordination for Burial and Other Support:

The committee works with the designated person(s) to coordinate burial arrangements and any other required support, following the instructions of the sub-committee director.

14.8 Support for Other Emergencies:

In cases of serious illness, natural or man-made disasters, or other emergencies affecting members, the committee collects detailed information and submits it to the sub-committee director to ensure the affected member receives the necessary financial or material support.

14.9 Community-Level Emergencies:

Beyond individual support, if emergencies affect the broader community in the city, the committee can mobilize volunteers from the association to provide assistance, with approval from the board of directors.

14.10 Financial Coordination:

The committee works with the finance and property director to determine the required amount of financial support for members in need and ensures the necessary expenses are covered.

14.11 Reporting:

The officer in charge of the sub-committee must submit a work report to the sub-committee director at least once a month, and, as needed, provide updates to the board of directors about the current support situation.

14.12 Oversight:

The sub-committee director, under confidential guidance, oversees all burial and related processes.

14.13 Grief Support Guidelines:

After a burial, the sub-committee issues detailed guidelines for managing the three days of mourning, ensuring that members receive appropriate support during this period.

14.14 Volunteer Coordination:

In collaboration with the Planning and Innovation Director and the volunteer management

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team, the committee organizes volunteers to assist with burials and other emergencies, whether natural or man-made.

7.6 Director of Social Programs

This role leads community engagement and social development programs.

Key Responsibilities

- Develop and manage youth, seniors, and newcomer programs
- Organize cultural, recreational, and community events
- Support vulnerable groups within the community
- Strengthen social cohesion and community participation

7.6.1. Samuel Bete Family, Youth, Seniors, and Refugee Support and Service Officers

Roles and Responsibilities:

1. **The officers' Committee Composition**
   This sub-committee must have at least three members. The Coordinator of the Committee is assigned by the Director of the Division among its volunteer members.
2. **Immigration Sponsorship Programs:**
   In coordination with the board of directors and relevant executive officers, the committee establishes and implements immigration sponsorship programs for association members.
3. **Educational, Social, and Cultural Development:**
   The committee creates and implements scholarship and award programs that promote educational, social, and cultural advancement.
4. **Economic and Living Conditions:**
   The committee develops and implements programs that help improve the economic and living conditions of the community.
5. **Health and Well-being:**
   The committee organizes and coordinates educational and service programs that support the physical and mental health of the community. It also encourages participation from both members and external stakeholders.

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6. **Youth Transition Programs:**
   When children of members reach 25 years old, the committee organizes special programs to help them understand the association's goals and benefits, ensuring continuity from one generation to the next.
7. **Support for Newcomers:**
   The committee organizes various support programs for new arrivals to Canada/Calgary and for community members, according to the association's capacity.
8. **Training Programs:**
   The committee develops and delivers various training programs for members and the community.
9. **Program and Service Management:**
   The sub-committee leader manages, coordinates, and supervises the delivery of programs and services.
10. **Special Assignments:**
    The committee carries out additional tasks as assigned by the sub-committee leader.
11. **Needs Assessment:**
    The committee regularly assesses the training and support needs of members and develops appropriate programs.
12. **Expert Involvement:**
    For training, the committee collaborates with experts and professionals, as well as the board, to deliver and enhance programs.
13. **Resource Provision:**
    The committee ensures that training venues and necessary resources are available to meet the needs of members.
14. **Partnerships:**
    The committee manages relationships with trainers and ensures responsible collaboration.
15. **Support for Seniors:**
    The committee develops and implements health and social programs to support senior members and others in the community at this stage of life.
16. **Utilizing Senior Experience:**
    The committee creates programs that allow seniors to share their knowledge and life/work experience.
17. **Youth Leadership Development:**
    The committee develops and facilitates support programs that help youth become future leaders.
18. **Healthy and Productive Community:**
    The committee creates conditions that foster a healthy and productive community.

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19. **Youth Participation:**
    The committee organizes and facilitates special programs and clubs to encourage youth participation and ensure continuity from one generation to the next.
20. **Social Events:**
    The committee organizes and implements social entertainment events, encouraging member participation.
21. **Community Engagement:**
    The committee develops initiatives that promote interaction, connection, and networking among members, and implements them with the approval of the executive committee.
22. **Monthly Reporting:**
    The committee leader submits a monthly activity report to the sub-committee leader.
23. **Regular Reporting:**
    The sub-committee leader submits at least one work report per month to the sub-committee leader.
24. **Special Assignments:**
    The committee carries out additional tasks as assigned by the sub-committee leader.

7.7 Director of Planning & Innovation

This role focuses on long-term planning, project development, and innovation.

Key Responsibilities

- Lead strategic projects and new initiatives
- Oversee monitoring and evaluation of programs
- Coordinate volunteer management systems
- Support digital transformation and technology adoption

7.7.1. Project Planning, Monitoring, and Volunteer Service Coordination Officer(s)

Roles and Responsibilities:

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1. **The officers' Committee Composition:**
   This sub-committee must have at least three members. The Coordinator of the Committee is assigned by the Director of the Division among its volunteer members.
2. **Project Initiation and Planning:**
   The officer is responsible for identifying and initiating major projects that align with the association's development and change objectives. These projects are proposed to the sub-committee director and the board of directors, and, once approved, are implemented in coordination with relevant officers.
3. **Project Progress Reporting:**
   The officer prepares regular reports on the progress of ongoing projects and submits them to the sub-committee director and the board of directors.
4. **Project Coordination:**
   The officer ensures that projects managed by different departments are implemented in an organized and coordinated manner.
5. **Budget and Performance Reporting:**
   The officer prepares and submits reports on project budgets and performance outcomes as needed.
6. **Volunteer Management:**
   For various social activities and projects that require significant manpower, the officer ensures that the necessary volunteers are recruited and organized.
7. **Volunteer Recruitment Systems:**
   The officer develops and manages systems for recruiting volunteers from both within the association and from other community groups or organizations.
8. **Volunteer Placement:**
   The officer coordinates with department directors to assign volunteers to various association activities based on their skills, interests, and experience.
9. **Volunteer Training and Legal Compliance:**
   The officer ensures that registered volunteers receive the necessary job training and that all legal requirements related to their roles are fulfilled.
10. **Service Certificates:**
    The officer prepares service certificates for volunteers, which are issued through the association president's office. [Samuel Ora... R2.9.docx | Word]

PART 8 - TERM OF SERVICE, SERVICE FEES & Election

8. Term of Service

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The term of service for elected and appointed leadership positions is as follows:

- Members of the **Board of Directors** serve for a **three-year term**.
- Officers and Sub-Committee Leads serve for **two-year renewable terms**, unless otherwise specified by the Board.
- Individuals may be re-elected or re-appointed based on performance, availability, and the needs of the Association.
- Directors may not hold the same executive position for more than **two consecutive terms**, unless approved by the General Assembly.

9. Service Fees (Compensation)

Except for the Administrative Support officer, all leadership and officer roles within the Association are volunteer-driven. Therefore:

- Board Members, Officers, and Committee Leads do not receive salaries, but may be reimbursed for reasonable expenses incurred while performing official duties.

- No individual may use their position for personal financial gain.
- Any conflict of interest must be declared immediately and managed according to policy.

10. Meeting Procedures & Elections Framework

10.1 Elections Committee — Structure & Participation

The Elections Committee is responsible for administering the election process. Its duties include:

- Preparing voter lists
- Managing nominations
- Organizing candidate presentations
- Ensuring fairness and transparency
- Overseeing voting and counting
- Announcing results

The Committee must operate independently and impartially.

10.2 Transfer of Responsibility

After elections:

- The outgoing Board must hand over all documents, records, financial statements, and assets to the newly elected Board within **30 days**.
- A formal handover meeting must be held, with minutes recorded.
- The Elections Committee oversees the transition to ensure compliance.

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10.3 Term of Office for Elected Leaders & Re-Election Rules

- Board Members serve a **three-year term**.
- Members may run for re-election.
- A Director may serve a maximum of **two consecutive terms** in the same position.
- After completing two terms, they must take a **minimum one-term break** before running again for the same role.
- Members may run for a different Board position without waiting.

10.4 Nomination & Eligibility Criteria

To be eligible for election:

A candidate must:

- Be a member in good standing
- Have no outstanding fees
- Have demonstrated active participation in the Association
- Possess the skills, integrity, and commitment required for leadership
- Submit a nomination form within the announced timeline

The Elections Committee may conduct background checks or request references if needed.

10.5 Voting Procedures

Voting may be conducted through:

- In-person ballots
- Secure digital voting platforms
- Hybrid methods, depending on feasibility

Voting Rules

- Each eligible member has **one vote**.
- Voting is **secret and confidential**.
- A simple majority determines the winner unless otherwise specified.
- In case of a tie, a run-off vote is held.

10.6 Special Elections

Special elections may be held when:

- A Board Member resigns
- A position becomes vacant due to relocation, illness, or misconduct

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- The General Assembly votes to remove a Director

The Elections Committee will organize the special election within **60 days** of the vacancy.

PART 6 — SUPPORT & BENEFIT PROVISIONS

11. Support and Service Conditions

The Sew Le Sew Mutual Aid Association provides support to members based on clearly defined criteria, fairness, and the principles of solidarity. All benefits are delivered according to the membership category, eligibility rules, and the Association's financial capacity.

11.1 General Conditions for Support Coverage

Support is provided under the following general conditions:

1. The member must be **in good standing**, with all monthly contributions up to date.
2. The event requiring support (death, illness, emergency, etc.) must occur **within the defined geographic boundary**, unless otherwise specified.
3. The member or their representative must notify the Association **as soon as reasonably possible**.
4. Support is provided according to the **type of membership**, the **nature of the event**, and the **policies approved by the Board**.
5. All support is subject to verification and documentation requirements.

11.2 Support Coverage by Membership Category

Different membership categories receive different levels of support. Below is a breakdown.

11.2.1 Household, Individual, Newcomer & Youth Membership and Parent Membership

These categories may receive:

- Funeral support
- Emergency assistance
- Illness-related support (as defined in policy)
- Social and community support services
- Access to programs and events

11.2.2 Temporary Membership

Temporary Members receive **limited support**, which may include:

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- Funeral support for the temporary member only
- Emergency assistance within the geographic boundary
- No long-term or extended benefits

Temporary Membership is valid for **12 months** and cannot be extended without Board approval.

11.2.3 Honorary Membership

Honorary Members:

- Do **not** receive financial benefits
- May receive symbolic recognition and participation privileges
- Serve as ambassadors and advisors

11.2.4 Partner Organization Membership

Partner organizations:

- Do **not** receive financial benefits
- May receive shared community support during joint events
- Contribute resources, space, or volunteers during emergencies

11.3 Special Circumstances & Humanitarian Support

The Association recognizes that members may face extraordinary situations requiring compassionate response. The following provisions apply:

11.3.1 General Humanitarian Circumstances

Support may be extended in cases such as:

- Severe hardship
- Unexpected crises
- Family emergencies
- Community-wide incidents

The Board may approve additional support on a case-by-case basis.

11.3.2 Health-Related Circumstances

Support may be provided for:

- Serious illness
- Hospitalization

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- Medical emergencies

The level of support depends on membership category and available resources.

11.3.3 Legal or Custodial Circumstances

Support may be considered when a member:

- Is detained
- Faces legal hardship
- Encounters immigration-related emergencies

Support is humanitarian in nature and does not include legal representation.

11.3.4 Social & Community Humanitarian Support

The Association may provide:

- Emotional support
- Community mobilization
- Volunteer assistance
- Cultural or social support services

This includes helping families during difficult times beyond financial assistance.

11.4 Property Use & Asset Management

The Association may own or manage property, equipment, or community assets. The following rules apply:

1. All assets belong collectively to the Association, not to individual members.
2. Assets must be used **solely for official purposes**, including events, support services, and community programs.
3. Members may access Association property only with prior approval.
4. Misuse, damage, or unauthorized use of assets may result in disciplinary action.
5. The Board is responsible for maintaining, safeguarding, and accounting for all assets.

PART 7 - FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT, ETHICS, DISCIPLINE & AMENDMENTS

12. Revenue Sources and Financial Management

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The Sew Le Sew Mutual Aid Association operates on a transparent, accountable, and community-driven financial system. All revenues and expenditures must align with the Association's mission and Bylaws.

12.1 Revenue Sources

The Association's income may come from the following:

12.1.1 Member Contributions

- Monthly membership fees
- Registration (entrance) fees
- Special assessments approved by the General Assembly

12.1.2 Loans (If Necessary)

The Association may obtain loans **only when essential**, and only with:

- Board approval
- Clear repayment plans
- Full transparency to the General Assembly

12.1.3 Fundraising & Community Programs

Revenue may be generated through:

- Fundraising events
- Community programs
- Cultural events
- Project-based initiatives
- Donations from members or supporters

All fundraising activities must comply with Canadian nonprofit regulations.

12.2 External Funding & Expenditure Conditions

12.2.1 Internal Revenue Allocation

Funds collected internally (from members) may be used for:

- Mutual aid support
- Administrative expenses
- Program delivery
- Emergency response

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- Community development initiatives

12.2.2 External Financial Support

The Association may receive:

- Grants
- Donations
- Sponsorships
- Partnerships

All external funds must be:

- Used strictly for approved purposes
- Documented and reported transparently
- Managed according to financial policy

12.2.3 Asset Acquisition & Management

The Association may acquire:

- Property
- Equipment
- Supplies
- Technology

All assets must be:

- Properly recorded
- Protected from misuse
- Used only for official purposes

13. Code of Conduct & Disciplinary Measures

The Association upholds a strong ethical foundation. Members and leaders must conduct themselves with integrity, respect, and accountability.

13.1 Failure to Fulfill Obligations

A member may face disciplinary action for:

- Repeated failure to pay monthly contributions
- Ignoring official notices
- Disrupting Association activities

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13.2 Failure to Fulfill Responsibilities

Discipline may apply when a member:

- Violates the Bylaws
- Abuses benefits
- Acts dishonestly
- Misuses Association resources

13.3 Breach of Trust

Serious violations include:

- Fraud
- Misrepresentation
- Intentional harm to the Association's reputation
- Misuse of funds

Consequences may include:

- Warning
- Suspension
- Termination of membership
- Legal action (if required)

13.4 Penalties

13.4,1. Failure to Fulfill Obligations Without Sufficient Reason

Number	Offense	1st	2nd	3rd	4th
13.**4,1,1**	Failure to attend annual general meetings or other required meetings without sufficient reason, if confirmed	$5 monthly penalty and a written apology	$5 monthly penalty and a written apology for second time	Decided by the Executive Committee	Decided by the Executive Committee
13.**4,1,2**	Failure to pay monthly dues on time	$5 monthly penalty	$5 monthly penalty and a written apology for second time	Decided by the Executive Committee	Decided by the Executive Committee
13.**4,1,3**	Failure to attend a funeral	Decided by the Executive Committee	Decided by the Executive Committee	Decided by the Executive Committee	Decided by the Executive Committee

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13.4,2. Failure to Fulfill Responsibilities Without Sufficient Reason

Number	Offense	1st	2nd	3rd	4th
13.4.2.1	Failure to attend assigned work	$5 penalty and a written apology	$5 penalty and a written apology for second time	Decided by the Executive	Decided by the Executive
13.4.2.2	Failure to submit a work report	Decided by the Executive Committee	$5 penalty and a written apology for second time	Decided by the Executive	Decided by the Executive

13.4.3. Breach of Trust

Number	Offense	1st	2nd	3rd	4th
13.4.3.1	Misuse of the association's funds	To be handled by the relevant court	To be handled by the relevant court	To be handled by the relevant court	To be handled by the relevant court
13.4.3.2	Improper use (of resources or authority)	To be handled by the relevant court	To be handled by the relevant court	To be handled by the relevant court	To be handled by the relevant court
13.4.3.3	Damaging the association's name verbally or in writing	Reprimand	Reprimand	Final decision by the General Assembly	

Notes:

1. Most penalties are determined by the Executive Committee, except for serious breaches (like misuse of funds or damaging the association's name), which may be escalated to the courts or the General Assembly.
2. The $5 penalty is applied monthly for certain repeated offenses.
3. Written apologies or warnings may be required depending on the nature and frequency of the offense.

13.4 Code of Ethics

All members, leaders, and volunteers must:

- Act with honesty and fairness
- Respect confidentiality
- Avoid conflicts of interest

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- Treat others with dignity
- Uphold the Association's values
- Use resources responsibly
- Promote unity and cooperation

14. Indemnity and Legal Protection

The Association shall indemnify and hold harmless its directors, officers, committee members, employees, and authorized volunteers from and against any claims, liabilities, losses, damages, costs, or expenses arising out of the good-faith performance of their duties for the Association, except in cases of willful misconduct, gross negligence, or actions taken in bad faith. This indemnification shall extend to reasonable legal fees incurred in defending any such claim.

15. Partnerships & Institutional Collaboration

The Association may collaborate with:

- Community organizations
- Cultural groups
- Faith institutions
- Nonprofits
- Government agencies

Partnerships must:

- Align with the Association's mission
- Strengthen community support
- Promote cultural exchange
- Enhance service delivery

16. Amendments to the Bylaws

The Bylaws may be amended when necessary to strengthen governance and adapt to changing community needs.

Amendment Procedure

1. Proposed amendments must be submitted in writing.
2. The Board reviews and presents them to the General Assembly.
3. Amendments require approval by **two-thirds (2/3)** of voting members.
4. Approved amendments take effect immediately unless otherwise stated.

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17. Continuity & Organizational Sustainability

The Association is committed to long-term sustainability. This includes:

- Strong leadership development
- Financial stability
- Youth engagement
- Transparent governance
- Community partnerships

The Board must ensure that systems, records, and programs are maintained for future generations.

18. Enforcement of These Bylaws

These Bylaws become effective upon approval by the General Assembly and remain in force until amended or replaced.

All members, leaders, committees, and volunteers are required to comply with these Bylaws.

19. Recognition of Supplementary Documents for This Bylaw

For the implementation of this bylaw, any supplementary documents, sources of information, and other process-related documents listed below, when prepared and submitted by the Board of Directors, department heads, and leaders, and properly reviewed and approved by the association president, shall become an official part of this main bylaw in the eyes of the law. After their adoption, these documents must be communicated to the members.

Document	Purpose
1. Board Policy and Governance Manual	Defines Board authority, responsibilities, decision-making standards, and governance procedures.
2. Conflict of Interest Policy	Prevents personal interest conflicts, ensures transparency, and protects the integrity of decisions.
3. Financial Policies and Procedures Manual	Establishes budgeting, expenditure controls, internal audits, reporting standards, and accountability mechanisms.
4. Support Fund Management Guidelines	Defines eligibility criteria, benefit levels, case assessment procedures, and fund protection measures.
5. Membership Categories, Rights, and Responsibilities Guide	Explains membership types, fees, rights, obligations, and participation expectations.
6. Document Control and Records Management Policy	Ensures proper document handling, version control, storage, and legal compliance.
7. Membership Registration and	Outlines how members join, update information, and

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Document	Purpose
Verification Procedures	maintain verified status.
8. Support Request Evaluation Procedures	Ensures support decisions are fair, consistent, and timely.
9. Revenue and Expenditure Management Guidelines	Provides detailed procedures for managing income sources and authorized expenditures.
10. Internal Control Checklist	Protects assets, strengthens oversight, and ensures proper fund management.
11. Procurement and Purchasing Policy	Ensures transparent, competitive, and ethical purchasing processes.
12. Member Privacy and Confidentiality Policy	Protects member information and ensures ethical and legal data management.
13. Elections Procedures Manual	Provides detailed rules and processes for conducting fair and transparent elections.
14. Annual Board Work Plan	Outlines yearly priorities, meetings, activities, and strategic actions.
15. Communications and Member Engagement Policy	Governs internal and external communication practices and member participation.
16. General Assembly Procedures Manual	Ensures legally compliant, well-organized, and properly documented annual meetings.
17. Member Support and Emergency Management Framework	Identifies potential risks and outlines response and mitigation strategies.
18. Meeting Agenda and Notice Templates	Ensures consistent, professional documentation for meetings and official notices.
19. Volunteer Engagement and Management Guidelines	Provides standards for recruiting, training, and managing volunteers.
20. Refugee Sponsorship Policy and Implementation Procedures	Ensures legal compliance, accountability, and proper execution of sponsorship responsibilities.
21. Support Request Form	Describes how members submit requests for assistance.
22. Financial Request and Reimbursement Forms	Ensures proper documentation and verification of expenses.
23. Audit Preparation Checklist	Supports annual financial review and operational compliance.
24. Incident Response Checklist	Ensures member-related incidents are handled properly and consistently.
25. Code of Conduct Manual	Provides detailed ethical standards and behavioral expectations for all members and leaders.

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